Speed flat-mating



TASK 1

The flatmate from hell

On your own: rank these habits from 1 (the worst) to 6 (you could live with it). **Then in pairs:** compare and explain your top two.

_____	leaves dirty dishes in the sink for days
_____	plays loud music late at night
_____	is always late paying the rent
_____	has friends round every weekend
_____	takes 40-minute showers every morning
_____	eats your food without asking

Adapted from: Clare, A. and Wilson, JJ (2011) *Speakout Upper Intermediate Students' Book*, 1st edn. Harlow: Pearson Education. Unit 1, lesson 1.1 'Ideal flatmates', p. 8. Photo: SpareRoom.

Discuss: Who do you live with now? Is it easier to live with family, friends or on your own? Why?

TASK 2

Words you will hear

Match each word in bold to its meaning.

1. My **lodger** still hasn't paid for last month. _____
2. You must wear a **label** to enter this building. _____
3. I am always **seeking** new friends wherever I go. _____
4. I can **buddy up** with you if you can't afford the rent alone. _____
5. **Choosy** people are hard to please. _____
6. I'm so **braindead** from working all day. _____

a. a name tag or badge · b. looking for · c. picky, hard to please · d. too tired to think · e. a paying guest in your home · f. share a room

In pairs, ask and answer:

1. Have you ever been a lodger, or had one? How was it?
2. What are you choosy about: food, clothes, friends?
3. When do you feel braindead?
4. Who would you buddy up with on a long trip? Why?

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TASK 3

What happens at speed flat-mating?

You've heard of speed dating. Now look at the picture. **Tick** what you think happens at a speed flat-mating evening.

- [ ] You visit lots of flats in one evening.
- [ ] You meet the people, not just see the room.
- [ ] You get a list of everyone who's there.
- [ ] Everyone wears a badge.
- [ ] Everyone there is looking for a room.

TASK 4

First listening

Audio 1 · The start of the program
Your teacher will play the recording.

1. Check your predictions in Task 3. Were you right?
2. What happens during the evening?

3. What two things are you given when you arrive?

TASK 5

Second listening

Audio 2 · Four people at the event
Your teacher will play the recording.

You will hear four people, one after another. **Match** each speaker to how they feel about speed flat-mating.

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Speaker 1 _____

Speaker 2 _____

Speaker 3 _____

Speaker 4 _____

a. It's important to be honest. · b. It's easy: you just know. · c. Confused. · d. Doesn't say.

TASK 6

Third listening

Listen again. **True or false?** Correct the false sentences.

1. Speaker 1's pink badge means he's happy to share a bedroom. T F

Correction _____

2. He started looking for a room about a month ago. T F

Correction _____

3. He understands exactly how the event works. T F

Correction _____

4. Speaker 2 knew straight away that her two best lodgers were right. T F

Correction _____

5. She enjoys showing people round her house. T F

Correction _____

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6. Speaker 4 thinks it's best to show people who you really are from the start.

T F

Correction

7. She hasn't met anyone she could live with.

T F

Correction

In groups: Would you go to an evening like this? What would put you off?

TASK 7

Get ready for the event

A. What would you ask a future flatmate? Sort the topics: write each one in a column below.

work | daily habits | cleaning | guests | noise | diet | partners | salary | politics | religion | music | references | weekends | allergies | hobbies | future plans

FINE TO ASK	ASK WITH CARE	OFF LIMITS

B. Useful language. Use these in your questions and answers.

ASKING WITH CARE

- Do you mind me asking what you do?
- Can I ask whether you smoke?
- Would you say you're a tidy person?
- How do you feel about having friends round?

TALKING ABOUT YOURSELF

- I tend to cook quite late.
- I'm the kind of person who washes up straight away.
- I'm not much of a party person.
- A deal-breaker for me is smoking indoors.

C. Write five questions you will ask at the event.

1. _____

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2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

TASK 8

Who are you tonight?

Your teacher will tell you which card is yours. **Fill it in**: you can be yourself or invent someone.

I have a room

White badge · you stay in your seat

The flat: where, how many bedrooms, rent a month

_____

The room: single or shared, what's in it

_____

Who lives there now, and one of their habits

_____

Three of my habits

_____

My deal-breaker

_____

I need a room

Pink badge if you'll share a bedroom · you move each round

My budget a month

_____

When I can move in, and for how long

_____

Where I want to live

_____

Three of my habits

_____

My deal-breaker

_____

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TASK 9

The event

Three and a half minutes with each person. When the bell rings, finish your sentence and give them a score. Room-seekers then move one seat.

ROUND	NAME	SCORE 1–5	WHY?
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

After the event: Who would you live with, and why? Tell the class in one sentence.

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